It is hard to believe that after prolonging the ceasefire for two more days, the war will resume and some 160 hostages will still be in the hands of Hamas. This will cause serious turmoil in Israel, and Netanyahu certainly doesn't want that. President Biden will put a lot of pressure on Israel and Arab states to get a further prolongation. That could also help his reelection in due course.

Benny Gantz and all members of his National Unity Party voted against the budget for 2023, supported by Netanyahu and Smotrich. Netanyahu also went from one Likud member of Knesset to the another to promise that he will make sure no Palestinian state sees the light of day.

Today, I feel shame. Yes, shame. The unit of the army I was a proud member of, the famous Unit 8200, which should have been the first to warn that something was happening on the other side on October 7, was probably asleep: instead of warning hours ahead of the attack, they mumbled something at 8:30 in the morning, some two hours after the attack. The whole intelligence force was a disgrace on that crucial day.

Tuesday, November 28

Further information about the complete unpreparedness of the army on October 7: the head of intelligence was on vacation in Eilat, and the head of the air force not asked to participate in a perfunctory phone conference with the chief of staff as vague indications came in about something happening in the South. This shows that the failure was not one of intelligence only, but one of the commanders of many branches of the IDF, from the very top.

The chief of staff said as much: "The army and the intelligence failed on October 7, but it isn't right for officers to deal with their responsibility today," he declared during a visit to the Northern Command.

The *New York Times* today published an article detailing the horrendous conditions in which the inhabitants of the northern part of the enclave